

Frog

Many frogs are surprisingly active parents. They spend a lot of time keeping their eggs moist and their tadpoles wet. Like most amphibians, frogs require water to complete their life cycle. This can be a challenge even in the tropical rain forests of Central America, the home of the strawberry poison frog.

Mating

A male attracts a female with his calls and may crawl onto her back before releasing sperm on a leaf. The female then lays her eggs so they can be fertilized by the sperm.

Carrying tadpoles

The female returns when the eggs begin to hatch. She sits on them and waits for a tadpole to wriggle onto her back. Then she crawls backward into a pool of water on the bromeliad plant and waits for the tadpole to swim away.

Guarding the eggs

The male guards the eggs, keeping them clean and moist with urine until they hatch into tadpoles.

The frog's colors warn predators that its skin contains deadly chemicals.

